

January 2026

To DCFS and the Judge,

My name is Maria Ruiz. I am Marcus's mother. I am writing this letter because I want the court to know that I love my son and I want him back. I know I made mistakes. I was not taking care of him the way I should have. I was dealing with a lot of problems and I was not in a good place. But I am trying to do better now.

I am asking for the chance to show that I can be a good mother to Marcus. I will do whatever the court tells me to do. I will go to the classes. I will go to the counseling. I will keep the house clean and safe. I just want to see my son.

I have not been able to visit Marcus because I moved and I lost my phone. I have a new number now. Please give my caseworker my new number so I can call about visits.

Thank you for reading this letter.

Maria Ruiz

Mother of Marcus D. Whitfield